

Heat of the action at Malaga
On the left, the French flagship, *Foudroyant*, commanded by the Comte de Toulouse, an illegitimate son of Louis XIV, is closely engaged with Admiral Rooke's flagship, *Royal Katherine*.

WAR OF THE SPANISH SUCCESSION

MALAGA



Date August 24, 1704
Forces English and Dutch: 53 ships of the line; French: 50 ships of the line
Losses none

Location South of Malaga, Spain

In early August 1704 an Anglo-Dutch fleet under Admiral Sir George Rooke captured Gibraltar from the Spanish. A French fleet under the Comte de Toulouse sailed from Toulon to retake it. Rooke met the French south of Malaga. The action was an indecisive slaughter, two powerful forces in formal line of battle battering one another with broadsides. Occasionally a ship withdrew because of the scale of the damage and casualties suffered, but no vessel had been lost by either side when they disengaged at the day's end. The Anglo-Dutch fleet was overall in worse shape and desperately short of powder and shot. But the French did not renew the battle next morning, instead sailing back to Toulon. Both sides claimed victory, even though the English retained Gibraltar.

WAR OF THE SPANISH SUCCESSION

LIZARD



Date October 21, 1707
Forces English: 5 ships of the line; French: 13 ships of the line
Losses English: 1 ship of the line sunk, 3 captured, 60 transport ships captured; French: none

Location Off Cornwall, southwest England

An English convoy of 80 transport ships sailed from Plymouth, bound for Portugal with men and supplies for the war then being fought in Spain. On the following day the convoy was intercepted off the Lizard by two French squadrons, one led by the Saint-Malo privateer Captain René DuGuay-Trouin and the other by Admiral Claude de Forbin.

With only five ships of the line to his opponents' 13, the commander of the English convoy escort, Commodore Richard Edwards, stood little chance. The English ships nonetheless formed up in line of battle and mounted a spirited resistance, hoping this would allow at least some of the transports to escape. Edwards' flagship, the 80-gun *Cumberland*, was captured after being attacked by DuGuay's 74-gun *Lys* and two smaller ships. The other 80-gun English ship, *Devonshire*, defended herself against overwhelming odds until dusk, when the ship exploded, killing more than 800 men on board. *Royal Oak* was the sole English warship to escape, reaching Kinsale in southern Ireland with a handful of transports.

WAR OF THE SPANISH SUCCESSION

CARTAGENA



Date June 8–9, 1708
Forces English: 3 ships of the line; Spanish: 4 galleons, 13 other vessels
Losses English: none; Spanish 2 ships destroyed, 1 captured

Location Isla de Baru, Cartagena, Colombia

Admiral Charles Wager with three English ships of the line—*Expedition*, *Kingston*, and *Portland*—intercepted a Spanish treasure fleet bound for Cartagena from Porto Bello. The two largest and most heavily armed galleons, *San José* and *San Joaquín*, were carrying most of the silver and gold bullion. The fight began late in the afternoon. Wager's flagship *Expedition* engaged *San José* in a lengthy exchange of broadsides. Darkness had fallen when the Spanish galleon suddenly exploded, showering *Expedition* with burning splinters of wood. In moonlight *Expedition* then engaged a smaller galleon *Santa Cruz*. Both *Kingston* and *Portland* joined him, allowing *San Joaquín* to steal away. *Santa Cruz* surrendered during the night and Wager sent *Kingston* and *Portland* to pursue *San Joaquín*. They found the galleon the following morning but failed to stop her entering Cartagena Harbor. Wager was furious at the failure to capture the bullion and the captains of *Kingston* and *Portland* were court-martialed. Still, his share of *Santa Cruz*'s valuable cargo made Wager a rich man.

Explosion of the galleon San José
The Spanish treasure ship, which still lies at the bottom of the Caribbean, is thought to have been carrying a fortune in silver, gold, and jewels.

